Global Remittances Report & Database

Concept note · First edition, November 2026 · Ratha Global LLC · Lead author: **Dilip Ratha**

1. Objective

The Global Remittances Report (GRR) will provide, twice a year in May and November, an authoritative account of remittance flows worldwide. Each edition will update the latest estimates for every country, review the economic, policy and regulatory developments that have shaped flows since the previous edition, and present a nowcast for the current year and a forecast for the next. The first edition, in November 2026, will cover flows through 2025, a nowcast for 2026 and a forecast for 2027.

Remittances to low- and middle-income countries are larger than foreign direct investment and official development assistance in many economies, and for a significant number of countries they are the largest source of foreign exchange. At the same time, the forces acting on them are shifting quickly: new and proposed taxes on remittances, tighter migration and border policies and deportations, cuts in official aid, tariffs and trade tensions, wars and conflicts, and the rapid spread of digital channels, including stablecoins. Policymakers and markets need a current, independent reading of what these developments mean for remittance flows.

The GRR will track outward as well as inward remittances and cover high-income countries as well as low- and middle-income ones, giving a complete picture of both sides of remittance corridors. Subscribers will also have access to the Global Remittances Database, comprising a country time series for about 200 countries and a bilateral remittance matrix of more than 10,600 corridors.

The GRR will be led by the economist who built the original series, compiled the first global tally of remittances, proposed the definition adopted in the IMF's Balance of Payments Manual, and created the bilateral remittance matrix. Data from the series he produced for the past two decades have been used by the IMF and the World Bank in debt sustainability analysis and by Moody's, Fitch and S&P in sovereign credit ratings. The data will also directly support two sustainable development goal (SDG) indicators: to increase the volume of remittances and reduce the cost of sending money. The report will be produced by Ratha Global, an independent firm with no affiliation with any government, international organization or remittance company.

2. Proposed outline of the report

Each edition will run to about 30 to 40 pages and will be organized in three parts.

1. **Global and regional trends and outlook.** Estimates of inward and outward remittance flows for 2026 and a forecast for 2027, for the world, regions and selected countries. Discussion of the main drivers: growth and labor markets in host economies, exchange rates, oil prices and migration. A forward-looking outlook, including upside and downside risks for countries that depend on remittances.
2. **Corridors, costs and channels.** Trends in selected corridors, in the cost of sending money, and in the shift from cash to digital channels.

3 **Policy and regulatory watch.** Taxes, tariffs and exchange controls in sending and receiving countries; visa policies, deportations and border controls; aid cuts; wars and conflicts; and regulation of payment service providers.

3. The Global Remittances Database

The database provides the numbers behind the report in ready-to-use CSV files, on consistent definitions across years and editions. It has two components.

Country time series. Annual inward and outward remittance flows and remittances-to-GDP ratios for about 200 countries from 2000 to 2025, together with the nowcast for 2026 and the forecast for 2027. The series is refreshed with every edition of the report, in May and November, and is available months before official balance-of-payments data for the most recent year.

Bilateral remittance matrix. Estimated flows for more than 10,600 remittance corridors covering 214 countries and territories, updated once a year with the November edition. The matrix uses an updated version of the methodology that Dilip Ratha introduced in 2007 and applied in every edition of the World Bank's bilateral remittance matrix through 2021. It provides the most detailed picture available of where remittances come from and where they go.

The database will be offered at several levels of access, from free open-access tier to enterprise licenses. Pricing and access terms are set out in a separate sheet.

4. Approach and data sources

Data on remittance flows are collected on an annual, quarterly or monthly basis from the IMF's balance-of-payments statistics and from central banks, following the definitions of the IMF's Balance of Payments Manual (BPM6). Where official data are missing or delayed, estimates are prepared using consistent methods and flagged as such. Nowcasts and forecasts start from estimated elasticities of remittances to growth, inflation and exchange rates in sending and receiving economies, and are refined with analysis of labor markets in host countries, migration and policy developments, and changes in remittance markets and regulation. The bilateral matrix is estimated by allocating each country's remittance receipts across source countries using data on migrant stocks and incomes in host and origin countries.

5. Audience and uses

The report and database are designed for readers who need reliable numbers on remittances for decisions, analysis and policy:

- **Remittance companies, payment firms and fintechs:** market sizing, corridor selection and competitive intelligence.
- **Governments, central banks and debt management offices:** balance-of-payments monitoring, external financing and policy design.
- **Investors, investment banks, commercial banks and credit rating agencies:** sovereign risk assessment and the external position of remittance-dependent economies.
- **International financial institutions, UN agencies and the G-20:** surveillance, debt sustainability analysis and development finance.

- **Universities, research institutions and market analysts:** research and teaching on migration, remittances and development.
- **Migrant and diaspora associations, foundations and civil society:** advocacy and programs on remittance costs and diaspora engagement.

6. Release and dissemination

The first edition of the report will be released in November 2026 together with the country time series, and the bilateral matrix will follow in December 2026. Subsequent editions will be published every May and November. Each release will be accompanied by a press release to international and national media, a launch webinar, and publication on rathaglobal.com, with notices to a network of policymakers, researchers, financial market participants and civil society organizations.

7. Planned developments

Over the coming editions, Ratha Global plans to add medium- and long-term remittance projections, with scenarios five and ten years ahead; interactive dashboards on a subscriber website that let users visualize and customize the data by country, corridor and indicator; and an archive of past bilateral matrices for analysis over time.

About the lead author



Dilip Ratha, Founder and CEO of Ratha Global, brings three decades of experience spanning the World Bank, MIGA, investment banking and academia. He is credited with compiling the first global tally of remittance flows, which helped bring remittances into the mainstream of the development agenda. He proposed the definition of remittances that led to the revision of the IMF's Balance of Payments Manual and is now used universally. He developed the original methodology for the bilateral remittance matrix in 2007 and published every edition of the matrix through 2021. He led 40 editions of the World Bank's Migration and Development Brief and founded KNOMAD and the African Institute for Remittances. In 2014, he delivered a TED Talk on remittances and diaspora bonds, which has been viewed more than 1.5 million times.

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Ratha Global is an independent firm. The Global Remittances Report is not affiliated with or endorsed by the World Bank or KNOMAD.